

SiyaBusa ERP

INCIDENT POST MORTEM TEMPLATE

Operations

Masaphokati Technologies (Pty) Ltd

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Department: Operations

Classification: Internal

WE RULE. WE GOVERN. WE EMPOWER.

OPERATIONS

Template for documenting and learning from incidents using blameless methodology.

Incident Post-Mortem Template

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Incident Overview

Field	Value
Incident ID	INC-[YEAR]-[NUMBER]
Incident Title	[Brief descriptive title]
Severity	P1 Critical P2 High P3 Medium P4 Low
Date of Incident	[Date]
Time Detected (SAST)	[Time]
Time Resolved (SAST)	[Time]
Total Duration	[X hours Y minutes]
Report Author	[Name]
Report Date	[Date]
Review Meeting Date	[Date]

Executive Summary

Write a 2-3 paragraph summary of the incident, suitable for executive stakeholders.

What Happened

[Brief description of the incident - what broke, what was affected]

Business Impact

[Summary of customer/business impact - number of customers affected, revenue impact, etc.]

Key Takeaways

[1-3 bullet points summarizing the most important learnings]

Incident Timeline

All times in SAST (South Africa Standard Time)

Time	Event	Actor
[Time]	TRIGGER: [What initiated the incident]	[System/Person]
[Time]	DETECTION: [How the incident was detected]	[Monitoring/Person]
[Time]	ALERT: [First alert triggered]	[System]
[Time]	ACKNOWLEDGE: [Incident acknowledged]	[Person]
[Time]	ESCALATION: [Escalation to additional team members]	[Person]
[Time]	INVESTIGATION: [Key investigation activities]	[Person]
[Time]	ROOT CAUSE: [Root cause identified]	[Person]
[Time]	MITIGATION: [Mitigation actions taken]	[Person]
[Time]	RESOLUTION: [Incident resolved]	[Person]
[Time]	VERIFICATION: [Resolution verified]	[Person]
[Time]	ALL CLEAR: [Incident closed]	[Person]

Impact Assessment

Customer Impact

Metric	Value
Tenants Affected	[Number / Percentage]
Users Unable to Access	[Number]
Transactions Failed	[Number]
Data Loss	Yes No
Data Exposure	Yes No

Service Impact

Service/Module	Impact Level	Description
Financial Accounting	Full Partial None	[Details]
Inventory	Full Partial None	[Details]
Sales & CRM	Full Partial None	[Details]
HR & Payroll	Full Partial None	[Details]
API	Full Partial None	[Details]
Reporting	Full Partial None	[Details]
[Other]	Full Partial None	[Details]

Business Impact

Impact Type	Assessment
Revenue Impact	R[Amount] or N/A
SLA Breach	Yes No
Service Credits Owed	R[Amount] or N/A
Reputational Impact	High Medium Low None
Support Ticket Volume	[Number] tickets created
Customer Escalations	[Number] escalations

Root Cause Analysis

Contributing Factors

List all factors that contributed to the incident

Factor	Category	Description
Factor 1	Technical Process Human	[Description]
Factor 2	Technical Process Human	[Description]
Factor 3	Technical Process Human	[Description]

Root Cause

Describe the root cause(s) using the 5 Whys technique

Problem Statement: [What failed/happened]

1. **Why?** [First why]
2. **Why?** [Second why]
3. **Why?** [Third why]
4. **Why?** [Fourth why]
5. **Why?** [Root cause - the fundamental reason]

Root Cause Summary

ROOT CAUSE SUMMARY

[Write a clear, concise statement of the root cause]

Example:

"The database connection pool was exhausted due to a memory leak in the query optimizer introduced in release v2.5.3. This caused cascading failures in the API layer when connections could not be obtained within the timeout period."

Technical Details

Include relevant technical information for engineering reference

Affected Components:

- [Component 1]
- [Component 2]

Error Messages/Logs:

[Paste relevant error messages or log entries]

Metrics/Graphs:

[Attach or reference relevant dashboards, graphs, or metrics]

Detection and Response

Detection

Question	Answer
How was the incident detected?	Monitoring Alert Customer Report Internal Discovery Other
Detection Method	[Specific alert/report that triggered detection]
Time to Detect (TTD)	[Time from incident start to detection]
Was detection timely?	Yes No - [Explain]

Response

Question	Answer
Time to Acknowledge	[Minutes from alert to acknowledgment]
Time to Mitigate	[Time from detection to mitigation]
Time to Resolve	[Total time from detection to resolution]
Response Team	[List team members involved]
Escalation Path	[Was escalation needed? Who was escalated to?]

Response Evaluation

Aspect	Rating	Notes
Detection Speed	Good Adequate Needs Improvement	[Notes]
Initial Response	Good Adequate Needs Improvement	[Notes]
Communication	Good Adequate Needs Improvement	[Notes]
Technical Response	Good Adequate Needs Improvement	[Notes]
Coordination	Good Adequate Needs Improvement	[Notes]
Documentation	Good Adequate Needs Improvement	[Notes]

Resolution and Recovery

Mitigation Actions

What was done to stop the immediate impact

#	Action	Time	Result
1	[Action taken]	[Time]	[Outcome]
2	[Action taken]	[Time]	[Outcome]
3	[Action taken]	[Time]	[Outcome]

Resolution Actions

What was done to fully resolve the incident

#	Action	Time	Result
1	[Action taken]	[Time]	[Outcome]
2	[Action taken]	[Time]	[Outcome]
3	[Action taken]	[Time]	[Outcome]

Recovery Verification

Check	Status	Verified By
Service restored	Pass Fail	[Name]
Data integrity confirmed	Pass Fail N/A	[Name]
Performance normalized	Pass Fail	[Name]
Monitoring confirmed	Pass Fail	[Name]
Customer verification	Pass Fail N/A	[Name]

Communication

Internal Communication

Audience	Method	Time	Content
On-call Engineer	PagerDuty	[Time]	Initial alert
Engineering Team	Slack	[Time]	Incident channel created
Management	Email	[Time]	Status update
Executive Team	Email	[Time]	Impact summary

External Communication

Audience	Method	Time	Content
Status Page	status.siyabusa.com	[Time]	[Status update]
Affected Customers	Email	[Time]	[Notification content]
All Customers	Email	[Time]	[Post-incident summary]

Communication Evaluation

Question	Answer
Was communication timely?	Yes No - [Explain]
Was communication accurate?	Yes No - [Explain]
Were appropriate stakeholders informed?	Yes No - [Missing: X]
Any customer complaints about communication?	Yes No

What Went Well

List things that worked well during the incident

#	What Went Well	Why It Helped
1	[Description]	[Impact]
2	[Description]	[Impact]
3	[Description]	[Impact]
4	[Description]	[Impact]

What Went Wrong

List things that didn't work well or could be improved

#	What Went Wrong	Impact
1	[Description]	[Impact]
2	[Description]	[Impact]
3	[Description]	[Impact]
4	[Description]	[Impact]

Where We Got Lucky

List things that could have made the incident worse but didn't

#	Lucky Factor	Potential Impact If Unlucky
1	[Description]	[What could have happened]
2	[Description]	[What could have happened]

Action Items

Immediate Actions (Complete within 1 week)

#	Action Item	Owner	Due Date	Status
1	[Action description]	[Name]	[Date]	Open In Progress Complete
2	[Action description]	[Name]	[Date]	Open In Progress Complete
3	[Action description]	[Name]	[Date]	Open In Progress Complete

Short-Term Actions (Complete within 30 days)

#	Action Item	Owner	Due Date	Status
1	[Action description]	[Name]	[Date]	Open In Progress Complete
2	[Action description]	[Name]	[Date]	Open In Progress Complete
3	[Action description]	[Name]	[Date]	Open In Progress Complete

Long-Term Actions (Complete within 90 days)

#	Action Item	Owner	Due Date	Status
1	[Action description]	[Name]	[Date]	Open In Progress Complete
2	[Action description]	[Name]	[Date]	Open In Progress Complete
3	[Action description]	[Name]	[Date]	Open In Progress Complete

Prevention Actions

Category	Action	Owner	Priority
Monitoring	[Improve detection]	[Name]	High Medium Low
Automation	[Automate response]	[Name]	High Medium Low
Documentation	[Update runbooks]	[Name]	High Medium Low
Training	[Team training needed]	[Name]	High Medium Low
Architecture	[System improvements]	[Name]	High Medium Low
Process	[Process improvements]	[Name]	High Medium Low

Lessons Learned

Key Learnings

What should the team take away from this incident?

1. [Learning 1 Title]

- [Detailed explanation]
- [How this will change our approach]

2. [Learning 2 Title]

- [Detailed explanation]
- [How this will change our approach]

3. [Learning 3 Title]

- [Detailed explanation]
- [How this will change our approach]

Process Improvements

Current State	Recommended Change	Expected Benefit
[Current process]	[New process]	[Benefit]
[Current process]	[New process]	[Benefit]

Supporting Documentation

Related Documents

Document	Link/Location
Incident Ticket	[Link]
Related Tickets	[Links]
Monitoring Dashboards	[Link]
Runbook Used	[Link]
Change Request (if applicable)	[Link]

Attachments

- ☐ Timeline diagram
- ☐ Architecture diagram
- ☐ Relevant logs
- ☐ Monitoring screenshots
- ☐ Communication samples

Post-Mortem Review

Review Meeting

Field	Value
Date	[Date]
Attendees	[List of attendees]
Duration	[X] minutes

Review Outcomes

Summary of decisions made during the post-mortem review

- 1. [Decision/Outcome 1]
- 2. [Decision/Outcome 2]
- 3. [Decision/Outcome 3]

Sign-Off

Role	Name	Date	Signature
Incident Commander			
Engineering Lead			
Operations Lead			
Product Owner			

Appendix

A. Severity Definitions

Severity	Definition	Response Time
P1 - Critical	Service completely unavailable; major business impact	15 minutes
P2 - High	Major feature unavailable; significant impact	1 hour
P3 - Medium	Feature degraded; moderate impact	4 hours
P4 - Low	Minor issue; minimal impact	8 hours

B. Post-Mortem Process

1. **Incident Resolved** → Document immediate findings
2. **Within 24 hours** → Draft post-mortem document
3. **Within 48 hours** → Complete technical analysis
4. **Within 5 business days** → Conduct post-mortem review meeting
5. **Within 7 business days** → Finalize document and action items
6. **Ongoing** → Track action items to completion

C. Blameless Culture

This post-mortem follows a **blameless** approach:

- Focus on systems and processes, not individuals
- Assume everyone acted with the best intentions
- Look for systemic improvements, not punishments
- Create a safe environment to share information
- Use incidents as learning opportunities

Document Control

Version	Date	Author	Changes
Draft	[Date]	[Name]	Initial draft
1.0	[Date]	[Name]	Finalized after review

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